War era. The American war on terror against Iraq and Afghanistan created a tight situation for the United Nations as a whole and especially the Secretary-General. However, the post-War reconstruction programme earned him praises. But he was accused of corruption relating to the Oil for Food Programme that tarnished the image of his office.

**Ban Ki-Moon** of the Republic of Korea, took over the office on 1 January 2007 as the eighth Secretary-General. He faced an alarming situation in the tussle between Russia and Georgia over South Ossetia and the increasing violence there. In the face of strong demand for revamping the United Nations and more positive actions of the UN in crisis situations places him in a tough position where every move of his has to take into consideration the post-Cold War international scenario, the presence of the sole superpower, and demands of the developing countries as well as those of the rest of the world community. Ban Ki-Moon has been voted unanimously for a second five year term as the Secretary General of the UN. The second term began from 1 January 2012 and will continue till 31 December 2016. This decision followed a recommendation by members of the Security Council which made Ban the eighth person to be re-appointed and serve a second term.

**António Guterres**, took over the office of the Secretary General on 1 January 2017. He has been a Portuguese politician and diplomat and has been serving the United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees for many years (2005-2015). He launched an appeal for peace and conveys the message for fighting climate change, terrorism and inequality, as well as rethinking about the role of the 72-year-old Organization. It has to be seen how he uses his expertise and experience to enhance the prestige and effectiveness of the UN.

Therefore, it becomes quite clear that the efficacy of the office of the Secretary-General depends on the personality of the person occupying the office, the current international scenario and, of course, the political equation among the major international players themselves and their relationship with the Secretary-General.[19]